

Own Your Mess

Ready for some truth? You are ultimately responsible for how well you're doing right now. Wherever you are, however you got there, you've got to own it. It's your responsibility. If your finances are a mess right now, though, that's still good news. Like Dave Ramsey says, "If you're the *problem*, that means you're also the *solution*." Taking ownership of how you got to this point may hurt, but when you do it, you're also taking ownership of the power to turn things around. This is a key characteristic of millionaires. Our study found that 95% of millionaires—almost *all* of them—are willing to quickly admit when they're wrong. They don't lie to themselves or others, and they don't waste time looking for someone to blame. Instead, they own up to their mistakes and start looking for ways to turn things around. That's what personal responsibility is all about. So, if you've driven your finances into a ditch, don't look for someone else to come along and pull you out. It's your problem to fix, and nobody—no charity, boss, or government program—will be more motivated to solve your problems than you are. So let's fix them.

Owning your situation begins with getting a clear picture of where you are—which, when it comes to money, means calculating your net worth. In chapter 1, I explained that net worth is simply everything you *own* minus what you *owe*. It's all your assets minus all your liabilities. That is the barebones, most basic way to track your progress toward millionaire status. Your net worth is essentially the blue dot that shows you exactly where you are on the financial map. You'll never know where you are or how much progress you're making until you start tracking this figure. Calculating this number is just basic math, and it won't take long to do. But don't put it off; do this *right now*. We're starting a journey with this book, and I want you to be able to look back on this day in a few years and know exactly how far you've come. To help, I've put a great net worth calculator on my site, www.chrishogan360.com. Go check it out.